Alexander Hempel

Senior Economist | Housing, Household Finance & Urban Economics

Ottawa, Ontario | +1 (416)-788-7123 | alexhempel6@gmail.com | www.hempeleconomics.com

Summary

Senior Economist at the Bank of Canada specializing in housing, household finance, urban and public economics. My research uses large administrative and microdata sources and applied econometric methods to study policy-relevant questions related to housing markets, financial services, wealth inequality, and local public finance.

Professional Experience

Senior Economist, Bank of Canada 2026–Present
Financial Stability Department, Real Sector Stability Division

- Conduct research and policy analysis on housing and household financial vulnerabilities in support of the Bank's financial stability mandate.
- Analyze large administrative and microdata sources to assess developments in Canadian housing and household finance.

External Consultant (*Mitacs Intern*), Bank of Canada 2025–2026
Currency Department, Joint Appointment with University of Alberta

- Conducted research on the banking sector and access to cash and financial services using Canadian credit bureau and branch-location data.
- Applied econometric methods to large-scale microdata to study consumer financial behaviour and the effects of changing access to bank branches.

Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Alberta
Alberta School of Business (Barry Scholnick), Joint Appointment with Bank of Canada 2025–2026
Resource Economics and Environmental Sociology (Feng Qiu) 2024–2025

- Analyzed large-scale administrative and economic datasets to study housing markets, household finance, immigration, and public finance outcomes
- Developed data-driven strategies to estimate policy impacts and economic relationships

Education

PhD in Economics, University of Toronto 2018–2024
Committee: Robert McMillan, Stephan Heblich, Jonathan Hall

- Thesis Title: *Essays on Housing and Wealth*
  - Conducted original research on housing markets and wealth inequality using complex, cutting-edge models of housing markets and wealth accumulation
- Graduate Courses: Urban Economics, Quantitative Macroeconomics, Industrial Organization, Public Economics, Labour Economics, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics, Econometrics

MA in Economics, University of Toronto 2017–2018
BA in Economics & European Studies, University of Toronto 2013–2017

Additional Experience

Course Instructor, University of Alberta 2025
AREC460 and AREC513

- Designed and delivered instruction on GIS and causal inference in undergraduate and master's-level

economics courses
- Communicated technical material clearly to students with varied quantitative backgrounds

Teaching Assistant, University of Toronto 2017–2024
Department of Economics

- Supported instruction across courses in microeconomics, macroeconomics, public economics, inequality, economic history, and sports economics
- Served as Lead Writing TA, helping improve the quality of written assignments across the department

Research Assistant, University of Toronto 2017–2020
Department of Economics

- Managed large datasets for econometric analysis and developed well-documented, reproducible workflows for research continuity
- Developed data visualization tools and contributed to a public-facing platform providing access to Canadian public finance data for researchers, policymakers, and the public

Skills

Programming: Stata, Python, Julia, ArcGIS, QGIS, Excel, R, MATLAB, SQL
Methods: Econometrics, Causal Inference, Policy Evaluation, Quantitative Analysis, GIS
Languages: English (native), French (advanced), German (intermediate)

Selected Research

Tightening the Belt: The Impact of Greenbelts on Housing Affordability
Estimates the effect of the Ontario Greenbelt on housing costs in the Greater Toronto Area using a structural model with heterogeneous supply elasticities and a nested logit demand system. Finds that the policy increased housing costs, but explains only a small share of the broader deterioration in affordability.

Wealth Inequality in Canada from 1990-2022: Evidence from the Capitalization Method
Forthcoming at the Canadian Journal of Economics
Provides new annual estimates of the Canadian wealth distribution from 1990–2022 using the income capitalization method, and compares trends with other Canadian estimates and other countries.

The Impact of Immigration on Local Public Finances: Evidence from Canadian Municipalities
with Feng Qiu and Sandeep Agarwal
Examines how immigration affects municipal revenues and budget balances in Canada between 2004 and 2022 using annual immigration data and a shift-share instrumental variables design.

Service

Referee, Journal of Urban Economics; Agribusiness 2024–2025
Co-President, Graduate Economics Union 2019–2020
Doctoral Student Mentor 2019–2022

Awards

Royal Bank Graduate Fellowship in Public and Economic Policy 2018
Department of Economics Essay Prize in Economic Policy 2015